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AS I WAS SAYING

by Bob Ingram

CLASS will tell in the long run—in almost anything.

Particularly is this true of baseball teams and baseball managers.

I might cite a lot of instances to prove this theory but I'm only going to mention one. That one has to do with the managerial career of Roy Johnson, manager of the belligerent Bisbee Bees.

It is no news that Johnson's club is setting the pace in the Arizona State league, one full game ahead of our Texans, and no matter what happens in the two remaining series of the season, Johnson has lived up to his reputation of consistently having his club in the money.

THE bellicose skipper of the Bees gathered a team that would have done credit to a Class "A" league when he was piloting the Ft. Bayard Vets in the old Copper circuit.

And in the three years he has been drawing a salary as manager of Bisbee in the Arizona State league, he has been in the thick of every flag race.

Two years ago, his club made the Phoenix Senators hustle to win the league bunting. Last year, Bisbee under his able direction, won the second half championship and met Miami in the playoff series. It is still some dispute just which team won in the playoff.

IT looked for awhile this season like Johnson was losing his magic. His Bees drew their mail in the cellar most of the first half, or close to the basement position.

But lately the fiery manager has been up to his old tricks. Bisbee has been giving all the other clubs in the league a fit, and is an even money bet to take the last half title.

Johnson did a lot of experimenting early in the season with most green players. The result was almost disastrous but some quick maneuvering and an almost new layout in the second half has once again put him up among the contending teams.

ONE OF THE PLAYERS who has helped Johnson in the present campaign is none other than Sydney Cohen, young El Paso star.

Syd has been playing a whale of a game with the Bees. His fielding, always his strong point, has been as lustrous as usual and he has been hitting above the .350 mark. When he can hit that way he is indeed a valuable player in anybody's league.

Johnson has two offers to sell Cohen. St. Louis Cardinals will take him on trial, and the Los Angeles Angels will buy him outright. Johnson is disposed to accept the latter offer.

TONY ANTISTA, the pint-sized outfielder, is another reason why the Bees are in the money. Antista is leading the Arizona State league hitters with several points to spare and nobody has heard any kicks about the way he tends the outer garden for the Arizona club.

Antista has been in faster company before and it has been one of the biggest mysteries out here why he didn't stay.

Johnson believes his smallness of stature has been a handicap to him.

A small player does not get the consideration a larger man would, Johnson reasons.

Another thing that has come to our ears is that Tony showed a weakness in fielding ground balls when he had his chance in higher company and would not hustle after one that he missed.

At any rate, Antista is hustling this year, and if he has any weakness it's not visible to us. It is more than likely that he will get another chance next season.

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